

NEXUS — The Campus Super-App

One Platform. Every Student. Every Need.

Founded at SRM Institute of Science and Technology | Scalable to Every Campus in India

Tagline: *"Your campus, your community, your economy — all in one place."*

TABLE OF CONTENTS

1. Executive Summary
 2. The Problem Landscape
 3. The Vision — What Is NEXUS?
 4. Core Platform Modules
 5. Unique Selling Propositions
 6. Market Analysis
 7. Competitive Landscape & Disruption Strategy
 8. Revenue Model
 9. Trust & Safety Architecture
 10. Legal & Compliance Framework
 11. Payment Infrastructure
 12. Go-To-Market Strategy
 13. Growth & Scalability Roadmap
 14. Team Structure
 15. Funding Strategy
 16. Risks & Mitigation
 17. Financial Projections
 18. Future Vision — 10-Year Horizon
-

1. EXECUTIVE SUMMARY

NEXUS is India's first vertically integrated campus super-app — a trusted, all-in-one digital ecosystem built exclusively for university students. Starting at SRM Institute of Science and Technology (Kattankulathur), NEXUS consolidates every economic, social, and logistical need a student has into a single, verified, and community-governed platform.

What NEXUS Does in One Sentence:

NEXUS is the **Uber + OLX + Swiggy + Fiverr + LinkedIn + Discord** for college students — but campus-verified, legally compliant, and designed specifically for the student economy.

Core Numbers (SRM KTR alone):

- ~20,000+ students on a single residential campus
- ~3,000 faculty & staff
- **Estimated campus economy: ₹15-25 Crore/month** (food, transport, services, goods)
- **Zero unified platform currently exists**
- **TAM across India:** 1,000+ universities, ~4 Crore college students

The Big Bet:

We are not building an app. We are building **the operating system of campus life in India** — and SRM is where we prove it.

2. THE PROBLEM LANDSCAPE

2.1 Fragmentation Hell

Every SRM student juggles 8-12 different apps and platforms daily:

- WhatsApp groups for buying/selling (chaotic, zero accountability)
- Instagram DMs for freelance work (no payment protection)
- Swiggy/Zomato for food (high delivery fees, not campus-optimized)
- Ola/Uber for cabs (surge pricing, no campus context)
- Noticeboard apps or physical boards for events
- Word-of-mouth for errands and micro-jobs
- LinkedIn/Internshala for gigs (not hyperlocal)

The result: Friction, scams, missed opportunities, and money leaving the campus ecosystem.

2.2 The Trust Deficit

In India's college campuses, peer-to-peer transactions are riddled with:

- Payment fraud (UPI sent, item not delivered)
- Fake listings (sold items re-listed)
- Service ghosting (freelancers disappearing after advance payment)
- No dispute resolution mechanism
- Safety concerns (meeting strangers on campus for transactions)

2.3 Money Leaking Out of Campus

Students collectively spend crores every month — but almost all of it goes to external platforms that take 20-30% commission and provide zero campus-specific context. Student sellers, service providers, and errand runners lose massive opportunities because there's no structured marketplace for them.

2.4 The Existing Competitor Gap

- **Rydin** (campus cab app) — single-purpose, no ecosystem
- **Helper** (errand app) — narrow, no trust layer, limited adoption
- **Campus Web Apps** — static, no economy layer
- **OLX/FB Marketplace** — zero campus verification, scam-prone
- **Swiggy/Zomato** — no campus-specific canteen integration, expensive

NEXUS solves ALL of these simultaneously.

3. THE VISION

3.1 Mission Statement

To build a trusted, inclusive, and thriving campus economy where every student can earn, discover, connect, and grow — safely and seamlessly.

3.2 Vision Statement

To become the default digital infrastructure of campus life for every university in India — and eventually across South and Southeast Asia.

3.3 The NEXUS Philosophy

Trust First. Every user is verified through their university credentials. Every transaction is escrow-protected. Every dispute has a resolution path.

Campus Native. Features are built for the physical reality of campus — walking distances, hostel logistics, mess timings, exam seasons, semester cycles.

Student Empowerment. NEXUS doesn't just serve students — it helps them earn, skill up, and build reputation. A student with 200 five-star reviews on NEXUS has a real, verifiable professional portfolio.

Community Governed. Campus moderators (elected students), faculty oversight, and AI-assisted content moderation ensure the platform stays safe and relevant.

3.4 The Super-App Architecture



4. CORE PLATFORM MODULES

4.1 NEXUS BAZAAR — Campus Marketplace (Buy/Sell)

What it is: A hyperlocal, verified second-hand and new goods marketplace, exclusively for SRM students and staff.

Key Features:

- **Verified Listings:** Every seller is a university-verified user; listings require photo + description
- **Smart Categories:** Books & Notes, Electronics, Cycles & Vehicles, Clothing, Lab Equipment, Stationery, Furniture, Appliances, Sports Gear, Musical Instruments
- **Condition Grading:** AI-assisted photo analysis suggests condition grades (Like New / Good / Fair / Rough) to standardize listings
- **Safe Exchange Points:** Designated, CCTV-monitored exchange zones on campus (partnered with university) — no meeting strangers in dorms
- **Price Suggestion Engine:** ML model trained on SRM-specific item pricing to prevent over/underpricing
- **Bid & Buy:** Option for auction-style listings (useful for rare electronics, vintage items)
- **Bundle Deals:** Sell your entire semester's books as a bundle at semester end

- **Flash Sales:** Time-limited sale events (End of semester clearance, hostel checkout sales)
- **Rental Module:** Rent items (formal wear for placement drives, camera equipment, sports gear) by the day/week

Revenue:

- 3-5% platform commission on each completed transaction
- ₹29-₹99 promoted listing fees for faster visibility
- "Verified Seller" badge subscription: ₹199/month

Anti-Fraud:

- Escrow holds payment until buyer confirms receipt
- Photo verification of delivered item
- Dispute window: 24 hours post-delivery
- Blacklist system for repeat offenders

4.2 NEXUS SKILLS — Services & Freelance Marketplace

What it is: A campus-native Fiverr/Upwork where students can monetize their skills and hire peers for tasks.

Service Categories:

Category	Examples
Academic	Assignment tutoring, exam prep, notes, proofreading
Tech	Coding projects, app dev, web dev, bug fixing, PCB design
Creative	Logo design, video editing, reels, photography, music
Career	Resume writing, LinkedIn optimization, mock interviews
Language	English coaching, Tamil/Hindi/foreign language tutoring
Fitness	Personal training, yoga, diet planning
Entertainment	Event hosting, DJ, comedy, magic shows
Administrative	Form filling, documentation, research, data entry

Key Features:

- **Skill Profiles:** Portfolio + rating + completed gigs — a real professional record

- **Milestone-Based Payments:** For larger projects, payments released in stages (like Upwork)
- **Collaboration Mode:** Students can team up to bid for bigger projects
- **NEXUS Certified:** Platform-administered skill tests for top categories (Coding, Design, Writing) — Certified badge boosts profile
- **Gig Packages:** Bronze/Silver/Gold tiers for each service (Basic ₹99 → Premium ₹999+)
- **Rush Orders:** Premium pricing for 24-hour turnaround
- **University-Affiliated Projects:** Faculty can post paid research assistant gigs directly on NEXUS Skills

Revenue:

- 10-15% commission on each completed service transaction
 - Promoted profile placement: ₹199-₹499/month
 - NEXUS Certified exam fee: ₹49 per attempt
 - Institutional accounts for faculty: ₹999/month to post verified gigs
-

4.3 NEXUS SWIFT — Errands, Micro-Jobs & Tasks

What it is: A real-time task marketplace where students post small jobs and others earn by completing them — campus-native TaskRabbit.

Task Types:

- **Errands:** Pick up food from canteen, courier from gate, print shop run, ATM cash pickup
- **Delivery:** Drop items to hostel rooms, deliver documents, pick up parcels
- **Assistance:** Help move furniture, carry equipment, assembly tasks
- **Queue Standing:** Stand in line at registration desk, bank, admin office
- **Research Tasks:** Survey completion, data collection, counting tasks
- **Typing/Digital:** Quick data entry, spreadsheet filling, PDF conversion
- **Facility Tasks:** Book a library seat, reserve a court, register for an event on behalf

Key Features:

- **Live Task Board:** Real-time map of available tasks on campus
- **Instant Accept:** Runner accepts task, timer starts — completion expected in defined window
- **GPS-Verified Completion:** Task completion verified by location check-in at destination
- **Swift Rating:** Both poster and runner rate each other after completion
- **Repeat Runners:** Post a task to a preferred runner directly (saved runners)

- **Batch Tasks:** Multiple runners needed for one task (e.g., 10 people needed to distribute flyers)
- **Automated Pricing Suggestions:** Based on distance, complexity, and time estimate

Revenue:

- 12% platform fee on each completed task
- Priority posting: ₹15 to jump to top of task board
- "Swift Pro" subscription for frequent users: ₹149/month (reduced fees, priority matching)

Safety:

- Cash is never exchanged — all payments through NEXUS Wallet
- GPS tracking during task execution (with consent)
- Emergency SOS button during active tasks

4.4 NEXUS FEAST — Campus Food Delivery

What it is: A hyperlocal food delivery network covering SRM's canteens, mess options, outside vendors, and student food entrepreneurs — optimized for campus geography.

Why External Apps Fail Here:

- Swiggy/Zomato delivery fees are high for short distances
- Campus canteens are not listed or poorly listed
- 200-meter deliveries don't fit 30-minute minimum windows
- No mess token integration
- No bulk order for hostel groups

NEXUS FEAST Advantages:

- **Direct Canteen Integration:** All 15+ campus canteens have digital menus on NEXUS Feast with real-time availability
- **Mess Integration:** Pre-book mess meals, swap mess tokens digitally
- **Student Food Vendors:** Students running tiffin services, home-cooked meal subscriptions, baked goods — all get a verified storefront
- **Dorm Delivery:** Delivery runners (from NEXUS Swift runner pool) handle last-mile delivery within campus
- **Group Orders:** Hostel room can pool orders — one delivery, split bill automatically
- **Scheduled Delivery:** Order breakfast at 11 PM for 7:30 AM delivery
- **Dietary Filters:** Vegan, Jain, Halal, Gluten-free — tagged on every item

- **NEXUS Feast Subscription:** Monthly subscription for daily lunch delivery — discounted rate for buyers, guaranteed revenue for vendors

Revenue:

- 8-12% commission per order
- Vendor listing fee: ₹299/month for premium canteens
- Surge delivery fee during exam weeks (shared with runners)
- Ad placements within the food browsing interface: ₹500-₹2,000/week per vendor

Legal Compliance:

- FSSAI licensing required for all food vendors on platform
 - Food safety rating displayed on each vendor profile
 - Allergen disclosure mandatory on all listings
-

4.5 NEXUS RIDES — Campus Mobility

What it is: A campus-specific ride-sharing, cab booking, and mobility platform — solving the #1 daily friction point for students (getting to/from campus, airport, railway station, city).

This directly absorbs Rydin's market while building a superior, integrated experience.

Services:

A. Campus Shuttle Sharing

- Students traveling from hostel to academic block / hospital / off-campus zones share rides in auto-rickshaws and cabs
- Real-time matching: 3 students going to Tambaram at 9 AM are pooled together
- Cost split automatically through NEXUS Wallet

B. Peer Ride-Sharing

- Students with bikes/cars list available seats for regular commutes
- Verified driver profile with vehicle details, license validation
- Co-passengers chip in fuel cost (not a commercial operation — eliminates permit issues)

C. SRM Gate Cab Booking

- Pre-negotiated rates with local cab aggregators at SRM gate
- Students book within NEXUS, fare displayed before booking, no surge negotiation
- Emergency late-night cabs with SOS tracking and friend-share location

D. Airport & Station Transfers

- Shared transfers from campus to Chennai Airport, Chennai Central, Tambaram station
- Weekly scheduled shared taxi service (5-6 AM airport runs, etc.)
- Advance booking up to 7 days

E. Rental Mobility

- Cycle and e-scooter rentals for within-campus movement
- Student-owned bikes listed for rent (hourly/daily rate)
- QR-code unlock system (hardware partnership)

Key Features:

- **Real-Time Ride Board:** Open board of all students traveling a particular route — request to join
- **Women-Only Rides:** Female students can filter for female-only co-passengers or female drivers
- **SOS + Live Tracking:** Location shared with emergency contact automatically
- **Driver Verification:** License, vehicle RC, Aadhaar verification for commercial drivers
- **Rating System:** Both driver and passenger rated after each ride
- **Campus-Aware ETA:** ETAs calibrated for SRM's internal roads (not Google Maps walking distance)

Revenue:

- 10-15% commission on each booked ride
- Monthly subscription for regular commuters: ₹199/month
- Advertisement from local cab operators for featured listing
- Premium SOS/tracking feature: ₹49/month add-on

Legal Compliance:

- Peer ride-sharing structured as cost-sharing (exempt from cab aggregator regulations)
 - Commercial driver partnerships handled through motor vehicle act compliant aggregator agreements
 - Insurance requirement for commercial drivers
-

4.6 NEXUS PULSE — Events, Communities & Teams

What it is: The social and discovery layer of NEXUS — the campus notice board, event ticketing platform, team formation engine, and community hub.

Features:

Events Discovery & Ticketing

- All campus events (fests, workshops, hackathons, club meetings, guest lectures) listed with verified organizer profiles
- Ticket booking with UPI payment — funds held in escrow until event happens
- Event-specific group chats auto-created for ticket holders
- QR code entry management for organizers
- Revenue sharing: NEXUS takes ₹10-₹25 per ticket as platform fee

Team Formation Engine

- Students post team requirements: "Need 2 designers and 1 PM for SRM Hacks"
- Filter by skill, year, department, availability
- Previous collaboration history shown
- **NEXUS Teams:** Persistent team profiles that build a reputation (like GitHub for collaborative work)

Clubs & Communities

- All SRM clubs get official NEXUS profiles (replacing scattered WhatsApp/Instagram)
- Club announcements, membership management, dues collection — all within NEXUS
- Inter-club collaboration matching

Gig Board

- Internship-like micro-gigs posted by startups, alumni, external companies — but campus-first
- Verified company/alumni posting only
- Applications, portfolio submission, and interview scheduling within platform

Notice Board 2.0

- AI-curated personal feed of campus news, opportunities, events
- Faculty-verified academic notices integrated
- Lost & Found board (with AI image matching for lost items)

Revenue:

- Event ticketing fee: ₹10-₹25 per ticket
 - Club premium accounts: ₹499/semester
 - Promoted event placement: ₹299-₹999
 - External company gig posting: ₹999-₹4,999 per listing
-

4.7 NEXUS WALLET — Unified Campus Payment Layer

What it is: The financial backbone of NEXUS — an RBI-compliant digital wallet that enables all transactions on the platform.

Features:

- **NEXUS Coins:** Internal reward currency earned from transactions, reviews, and challenges — redeemable across all platform services
- **Escrow Engine:** Every B2C transaction held in escrow until completion confirmed
- **Split Payment:** Shared bills for food, rides, and events split automatically
- **UPI Integration:** Razorpay/Cashfree gateway for loading wallet, payouts to bank
- **Instant Payout:** Sellers and service providers receive money within 2 hours of transaction confirmation (T+0 settlement where possible)
- **Spending Analytics:** Students see where their money goes — categories, trends
- **Parental Controls (Optional):** Parents can load wallet and set category spending limits (popular with first-year students)
- **NEXUS Card (Future):** Co-branded prepaid card with a bank partner, usable campus-wide

Revenue:

- Float income on wallet balances
 - Transaction fee: 0.5% on withdrawals above ₹5,000/month
 - Premium Wallet features: ₹49/month
-

5. UNIQUE SELLING PROPOSITIONS

5.1 The Trust Stack (Our #1 Moat)

NEXUS is the **only** campus platform where every user is verified through institutional credentials. This single feature eliminates 80% of fraud risk and creates a social accountability layer that no external platform can replicate.

The Trust Stack:

Level 1: University Email Verification (Day 0)
Level 2: SRM ID Card Photo Match (Week 1)
Level 3: Phone Number + Aadhaar Linkage (Optional, unlocks higher limits)
Level 4: Community Rating Score (Ongoing – your reputation)
Level 5: NEXUS Trust Score (Composite AI score – transaction history, ratings, dispute record)

5.2 Campus-Native Intelligence

NEXUS knows things no external app can know:

- Exam schedules (demand spikes for tutoring, food delivery)
- Hostel layouts (optimized delivery routing)
- Semester cycle (clearance sales at semester end, book demand at semester start)
- Campus events (demand for rides, food, teams)
- Faculty & department structure (relevant skill matching)

This intelligence drives better recommendations, smarter pricing, and higher conversion rates than any general-purpose platform.

5.3 The Network Effect Flywheel

More students join → More listings/services available
→ Better prices & faster fulfillment
→ More students join
→ More data → Smarter platform
→ MORE value for everyone

Once NEXUS hits 40% penetration at SRM, network effects become insurmountable for any competitor.

5.4 The "SRM Monopoly" Play

We are not trying to compete with Swiggy or OLX campus-wide. We are building a **walled garden** of trust and convenience that makes it irrational for any SRM student to use anything else. Once we own one campus completely, we are the most compelling B2B partner for every food vendor, cab operator, club, and event organizer in the 5-km radius.

5.5 Data as Infrastructure

Every transaction, every preference, every interaction on NEXUS creates a dataset that is impossible for anyone else to have: the real-time economic pulse of SRM. This data is:

- Priceless for marketing partners targeting students
- Invaluable for alumni networks and recruiters

- Essential for university administration (anonymized)
- Foundational for our expansion playbook to the next campus

6. MARKET ANALYSIS

6.1 SRM KTR Campus — Addressable Market

Category	Est. Monthly Spend	NEXUS Capture (Y1)	NEXUS Capture (Y3)
Food & Canteen	₹5 Cr	₹50L	₹2 Cr
Transport	₹1.5 Cr	₹20L	₹75L
Second-hand goods	₹80L	₹20L	₹55L
Services & Skills	₹60L	₹10L	₹40L
Events & Tickets	₹40L	₹15L	₹30L
Errands/Micro-jobs	₹30L	₹8L	₹20L
Total	₹~8.6 Cr/mo	₹1.23 Cr/mo	₹4.2 Cr/mo

6.2 Expansion Market — India University TAM

Segment	Count	Students	Monthly Spend (est.)
IITs & NITs	31	3L	₹450 Cr/mo
Deemed Universities	126	25L	₹3,750 Cr/mo
State Universities	400+	1.5 Cr	₹22,500 Cr/mo
Private Colleges	1000+	2 Cr	₹30,000 Cr/mo
Total TAM	~1,557	~4 Cr	~₹56,700 Cr/mo

NEXUS Realistic SAM (5 Years): 50 campuses × ₹2 Cr/mo = ₹100 Cr/month GMV → ₹1,200 Cr/year GMV → ₹120–180 Cr net revenue at 10–15% take rate.

6.3 Student Demographics at SRM (Buyer Persona)

The Core User: "The SRM Student"

- Age 18–23, digitally native, UPI-first, social media-heavy
- Spends ₹8,000–₹25,000/month (parental allowance + part-time)

- Wants convenience, speed, and affordability
- High trust in peer networks, low trust in strangers
- Motivated to earn extra income (skill monetization, errands)
- Heavy usage of WhatsApp, Instagram, YouTube, Swiggy

Key Insight: This user already does 80% of what NEXUS offers — just across 8 fragmented channels. NEXUS isn't changing behavior; it's consolidating it.

7. COMPETITIVE LANDSCAPE & DISRUPTION STRATEGY

7.1 Direct Competitors at SRM

Competitor	What They Do	NEXUS Advantage
Rydin	Campus cab booking	Integrated into full super-app; better UX; network effect
Helper	Errand app	Trust layer; wallet integration; larger runner pool
Campus Web Apps	Info portals	Dynamic economy layer; not just information
WhatsApp Groups	Informal buy/sell	Verification, escrow, search, ratings — infinitely better
OLX/Facebook	General marketplace	Campus verification eliminates fraud; hyperlocal context
Swiggy/Zomato	Food delivery	Campus canteen integration; lower fees; runner network
Internshala	Gig listings	Hyperlocal, real-time; campus-specific; integrated payment

7.2 How to Make Competitors Obsolete

Phase 1 — The Platform Trap: Offer Rydin and Helper integration as "NEXUS Partners" initially. This gets their users onto NEXUS. Then gradually replicate their features internally, making the partnership unnecessary. Classic platform playbook (see: Facebook with apps, Amazon with sellers).

Phase 2 — The Network Lock-In: Once NEXUS Wallet, ratings, and trust scores are established, switching to any competitor means starting over — no rating history, no coins, no verified profile. The switching cost becomes enormous.

Phase 3 — The Exclusive Deal: Negotiate exclusive campus food vendor agreements, preferential gate cab partnerships, and official university integration — making NEXUS the only authorized campus platform.

7.3 The University Partnership as a Moat

The single biggest competitive moat: **an official MOU with SRM administration.**

If NEXUS is recognized as an official university platform (for notice boards, club management, mess token integration, etc.), no competitor can legitimately operate on campus. We pursue this aggressively from Day 1 by solving admin pain points (event management, lost & found, notice distribution) for free.

8. REVENUE MODEL

8.1 Primary Revenue Streams

Stream	Mechanism	Year 1 (₹)	Year 3 (₹)
Transaction Commissions	5-15% on all platform transactions	60L	3.5 Cr
Subscription Plans	Pro sellers, vendors, clubs	12L	80L
Promoted Listings	Paid placement across all modules	8L	60L
Event Ticketing	₹10-₹25 per ticket platform fee	6L	45L
Food Vendor Fees	Monthly listing + commission	10L	70L
NEXUS Coins Premium	Purchasing extra coins/cashback	4L	30L
Advertising	Targeted ads for brands reaching students	5L	1 Cr
Data Insights (B2B)	Anonymized campus trend reports to brands	0	50L
University B2B	Admin tools, official integration license	0	25L
Total Revenue		~1.05 Cr	~7.1 Cr

(Single campus: SRM KTR. Year 3 projections post-product-market-fit and operational efficiency)

8.2 NEXUS Pro — Subscription Tiers

Plan	Price	Benefits
Student Free	₹0	Basic access to all modules; 3% transaction fee
Student Pro	₹99/month	Zero platform fee on sales under ₹500, priority support, profile badge
Seller Plus	₹199/month	Promoted listing slots, advanced analytics, lower commission (8% → 5%)

Plan	Price	Benefits
Swift Pro	₹149/month	Priority task matching, reduced Swift fee (12% → 8%), dedicated runner badge
Vendor	₹499/month	Full vendor dashboard, analytics, promoted placement in FEAST
Club	₹499/semester	Verified club profile, event creation tools, member management

8.3 The NEXUS Coins Economy

NEXUS Coins are the internal loyalty currency that drives engagement and reduces cash churn.

Earning Coins:

- ₹1 = 1 Coin on all transactions
- Completing profile: 500 Coins
- First transaction (buy or sell): 200 Coins
- 5-star rating received: 50 Coins/rating
- Referring a new user: 300 Coins
- Daily login streak: 10–50 Coins

Spending Coins:

- 100 Coins = ₹1 off any service
- Redeem for promoted listing slots
- Entry into NEXUS Coin Auctions (exclusive items)
- Food discounts at partner canteens
- Ride discounts

Why This Matters for Revenue: Coins drive daily active usage. Users who engage daily have 5x higher transaction frequency. Coins also create a liquidity mechanism — brands can buy Coin bundles to distribute as offers (a revenue stream).

8.4 Advertising Model

NEXUS will run India's most targeted student advertising platform:

Why Advertisers Will Pay Premium:

- 100% verified student demographics (year, department, spending behavior)
- Behavioral data (what they buy, when they're hungry, when they need transport)
- Contextual placement (food ad when browsing FEAST; cab ad when booking events)

Ad Products:

- In-feed native ads (blends with marketplace listings)
- Sponsored canteen slots in FEAST
- Event sponsorship banners in PULSE
- "Powered by [Brand]" in specific features

Target Advertisers: EdTech companies (BYJU's, Unacademy, Coursera), FMCG brands, fashion apps, banking apps targeting first-time credit users, laptop/phone brands.

Revenue Projection: ₹5,000 CPM (Cost per 1,000 impressions) in Year 1 → ₹15,000 CPM in Year 3 as audience size and verification premium grows.

9. TRUST & SAFETY ARCHITECTURE

This is NEXUS's #1 product differentiator and #1 operational challenge. We must get this right before anything else.

9.1 User Verification Flow

STEP 1: University Email

- User registers with @srmist.edu.in email
- OTP verification confirms live email access

STEP 2: Student ID Verification

- Upload SRM ID card photo
- AI OCR extracts student name, ID number, department
- Cross-referenced against official SRM database (if partnership obtained)
OR manual review queue (if no direct DB access)
- Human reviewer spot-checks 20% of all verifications

STEP 3: Phone Verification

- Mandatory phone OTP
- Number checked against TRAI blacklist

STEP 4: Face Match (Optional – unlocks higher wallet limits)

- Selfie compared to ID card photo using facial recognition API
- Confirms the person registering is the student

STEP 5: Aadhaar Linkage (Optional – for high-value transactions)

- DigiLocker API integration
- Unlocks ₹10,000+ transaction limits and commercial listings

9.2 Escrow & Transaction Protection

How Escrow Works on NEXUS:

Escrow Rules:

- Funds released after buyer confirmation OR 24 hours (whichever first)
- Dispute window: 24 hours after "delivered" status
- Disputed funds held for up to 7 days
- Refund to buyer or release to seller after mediation

9.3 Rating & Reputation System

Every user has a **NEXUS Trust Score (NTS)** — a composite score that gates access to platform features:

NTS Level	Score	Unlocked Features
Newcomer	0-2.9	Basic listings; ₹500 wallet limit
Member	3.0-3.9	Full listings; ₹2,000 wallet limit
Trusted	4.0-4.4	Priority placement; ₹5,000 limit
Star	4.5-4.7	Promoted for free occasionally; ₹10,000 limit
Elite	4.8-5.0	NEXUS Elite badge; priority support; ₹25,000 limit

Manipulation Prevention:

- Fake review detection algorithm (patterns in timing, reviewer history)
- Minimum 1 transaction required before rating
- Rating disputes possible for provably fake reviews
- Reviews with no text description weighted lower

9.4 Dispute Resolution System

Tier 1 — AI Resolution: Clear-cut cases (no delivery GPS check-in, buyer never rated, payment proof provided) resolved automatically within 2 hours.

Tier 2 — Campus Mediator: Student mediators (trained volunteers, senior students) review evidence — photos, chat logs, GPS data. Resolution within 24 hours.

Tier 3 — NEXUS Support: Complex cases reviewed by NEXUS support team. Resolution within 72 hours. May involve monetary compensation from platform.

Tier 4 — Legal Escalation: Cases involving fraud, harassment, or criminal activity referred to campus security or police with full documentation. NEXUS cooperates fully with law enforcement.

9.5 Anti-Fraud & Abuse Prevention

Known Fraud Patterns & Countermeasures:

Fraud Pattern	NEXUS Counter
"Pay me outside the app" persuasion	In-app messaging monitored for external payment solicitation; warning + suspension
Listing item already sold	Automatic "Available" check before purchase; seller must confirm availability
Fake delivery claim	GPS check-in at buyer location required for delivery completion
Multiple accounts (ban evasion)	Device fingerprinting + phone number uniqueness
Review manipulation	Velocity checks on reviewer accounts; graph analysis
Phishing via DMs	Link scanning in in-app messages; phishing URL blocklist
Advance payment scam	Escrow mandatory — no direct payment to seller until delivery
Identity theft	Facial recognition check for high-value account activities

9.6 Content Moderation

Prohibited Listings (Immediate Removal + Account Flag):

- Drugs, narcotics, or paraphernalia
- Counterfeit academic certificates, exam papers, or university materials
- Weapons (including pepper spray listed deceptively)
- Stolen goods (detected via serial number reporting)
- Plagiarism services (essays, assignments written for others)
- Any sexual content

AI Moderation: Image scanning for prohibited items on every new listing. Text analysis for prohibited service descriptions.

Community Reporting: Any user can report a listing. 3 independent reports trigger automatic review hold.

10. LEGAL & COMPLIANCE FRAMEWORK

10.1 Business Structure

Recommended Entity: Private Limited Company under Companies Act, 2013

- Name: **NEXUS Campus Technologies Private Limited**
- Registered Address: Kattankulathur, Tamil Nadu (or Chennai for urban address)
- Directors: Founders (minimum 2)
- Authorized Share Capital: ₹10,00,000 (initial)

Regulatory Registrations Required:

- GST Registration (mandatory once annual turnover exceeds ₹20L, or from Day 1 for B2B)
- Shops & Establishments Act registration (Tamil Nadu)
- Professional Tax Registration
- MSME/Udyam Registration (for benefits)

10.2 Payment Aggregator Compliance

RBI Regulations for Payment Aggregators (PA): NEXUS will use a licensed Payment Aggregator (Razorpay, Cashfree, or Paytm Payment Gateway) for all UPI/card transactions. This means NEXUS is a **Payment Aggregator Customer** — not a PA itself. The licensed PA handles all RBI compliance.

NEXUS Wallet: If NEXUS Wallet stores user funds beyond "pass-through" (i.e., holds money overnight), it may require a **Prepaid Payment Instrument (PPI) License** from RBI.

Compliant Structure:

- Option A: Implement escrow via bank account; release after confirmation (no PPI needed)
- Option B: Partner with a PPI-licensed entity (e.g., Razorpay's PPI arm) for wallet features
- Option C: Apply for PPI license once GMV > ₹10 Cr/month (timeline: 12-18 months)

10.3 The Ride-Sharing Legal Structure

Critical Legal Nuance — Peer Ride-Sharing:

India's Motor Vehicles Act and ONDC framework creates ambiguity for peer ride-sharing. NEXUS structures this legally by:

1. **Cost-Sharing Model (not commercial):** Rides between students sharing vehicles are structured as "co-passenger cost contribution" — legally distinct from commercial cab services. No driver profit — only fuel cost division.
2. **Aggregator License (for commercial drivers):** For third-party cab bookings (gate cabs, airport transfers), NEXUS must register as a "Transportation Network Company" under

each state's aggregator framework, OR partner with an already-licensed aggregator (Ola Enterprise, etc.) under a white-label arrangement.

3. **Two-Sided Liability Shield:** Terms of Service clearly establish that NEXUS is a platform intermediary, not a carrier. Liability for accidents rests with the vehicle owner/driver.
4. **Mandatory Insurance:** All vehicles listed for rides must have valid third-party insurance. Verified at onboarding.

10.4 Food Platform Compliance

FSSAI Requirements:

- NEXUS, as a food delivery platform, must register as an **E-Commerce Food Business Operator (FBO)** with FSSAI
- All vendors listed on NEXUS Feast must have valid FSSAI licenses (State or Central based on turnover)
- NEXUS must display vendor FSSAI license numbers prominently
- Mandatory allergen information on all food listings
- Non-compliant vendors removed within 48 hours of license expiry

GST on Food:

- Restaurants/canteens pay GST; NEXUS collects and remits appropriately
- Delivery charges may be taxed at 18% GST

10.5 Data Privacy & IT Compliance

Information Technology Act, 2000 & DPDP Act, 2023:

- Obtain explicit consent for all data collection at registration
- Publish clear Privacy Policy and Terms of Service (legally reviewed)
- Data localization: All user data stored on India-based servers
- Right to deletion: Users can request complete data deletion (30-day SLA)
- Data breach notification: Mandatory disclosure within 72 hours if breach occurs

Sensitive Personal Data:

- Aadhaar numbers never stored on NEXUS servers — DigiLocker API returns only verification confirmation
- Payment card details never stored — handled entirely by PA gateway
- Facial recognition data stored only in encrypted hash form

10.6 Employment & Gig Worker Compliance

The Gig Worker Question: Swift runners, Feast delivery runners — are they employees or contractors?

NEXUS Position: Platform intermediaries. Gig workers are independent service providers.

Required Protections (compliant with emerging gig worker regulations in India):

- Clear platform agreement (not employment contract)
- No minimum hours or exclusivity requirements
- Transparent fee structure (no hidden deductions)
- Earnings statements provided monthly
- If runner earnings exceed ₹7,500/month: ESIC-equivalent coverage discussion (regulatory in progress)

10.7 Consumer Protection

Consumer Protection (E-Commerce) Rules, 2020:

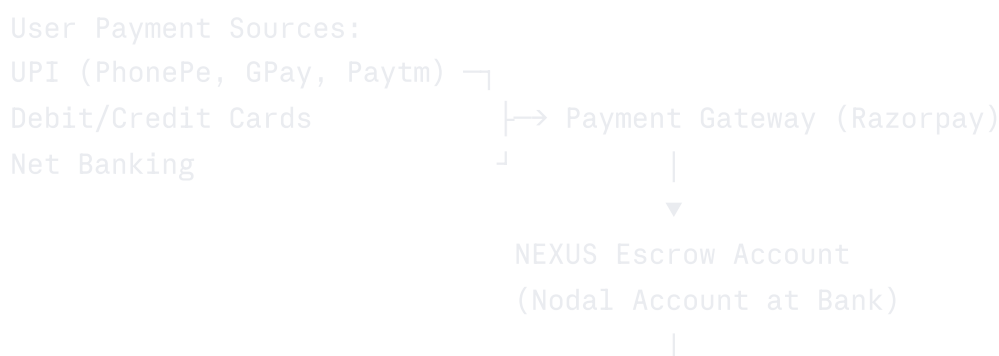
- Clear grievance redressal officer appointed and contact displayed
- Refund policy clearly stated for each module
- No "dark patterns" in UI (no forced subscriptions, confusing cancellation)
- Grievance response within 48 hours (regulatory requirement)

Student-Specific Protections:

- No targeting of minors (students under 18 — rare but possible in some programs)
- Parental consent mechanism for users under 18
- No predatory lending or BNPL products

11. PAYMENT INFRASTRUCTURE

11.1 Payment Stack





11.2 Nodal Account Structure

All marketplace payments flow through a **nodal account** — a regulatory requirement for online marketplaces in India. The nodal account is a dedicated bank account (Axis/HDFC/ICICI recommended) where:

- Buyer payments are received
- Funds are held during escrow period
- Seller payouts are disbursed

NEXUS commissions are extracted before disbursement. This is standard practice and RBI-compliant.

11.3 Settlement Timelines

Transaction Type	Settlement to Seller
Goods (Bazaar)	T+1 after delivery confirmation
Services (Skills)	T+1 after milestone completion
Swift Tasks	Instant (escrow auto-releases on GPS completion)
Food (Feast)	T+0 (real-time settlement to canteen)
Rides	T+0 (after ride completion)

11.4 Handling Cash — The No-Cash Policy

NEXUS is **100% cashless**. No cash exchange is permitted for any transaction. This is both a fraud prevention measure and an operational simplification.

Enforcement:

- In-app messaging warns users asking for "cash outside app"
- Repeat offenders suspended
- Safe exchange zones are monitored

This is reinforced culturally: "NEXUS users don't carry cash." The brand identity is built around this.

11.5 GST & TDS Compliance

- GST invoices auto-generated for every transaction above ₹200 (configurable)
 - TDS deducted at source for service payments above ₹30,000/year per user (per Section 194C of Income Tax Act)
 - Annual Form 16A issued to eligible users (sellers earning above threshold)
 - NEXUS files quarterly TDS returns
-

12. GO-TO-MARKET STRATEGY

12.1 Phase Zero — The Seed Campaign (Months -2 to 0)

Before the app launches, we build the mythology.

Actions:

- "NEXUS is coming to SRM" — mysterious campus poster campaign, Instagram reels, WhatsApp teaser
- Founding Community: Recruit 200 "Founding Members" across all departments manually
- Founding Members get: Lifetime "Founding Member" badge, 3 months of Pro free, first-mover advantage in listings
- Canteen vendor outreach: Pre-sign 5-8 major canteens before launch day
- Rider outreach: Sign up 20 gate cab drivers in NEXUS Rides
- Student org outreach: Brief all major clubs — NEXUS will replace their WhatsApp group chaos

Goal: 500+ pre-registrations before app goes live.

12.2 Launch Day — "SRM Goes Nexus" Event

Campus Launch Event:

- Partnered with a major SRM club (Aaruush or similar)
- Live demo at a visible campus location (near main canteen)
- First 500 users get ₹100 NEXUS Coins for free (funded by marketing budget)
- Live transaction demonstration — buy/sell/order/ride — in real time
- Social media blast: reels, stories, live stream

PR:

- Press coverage from student newspapers, SRM's own media
- LinkedIn posts by founding team — build personal brands simultaneously

12.3 Growth Engine — The Viral Loops

Loop 1: Referral Program Every user who refers a friend who completes their first transaction earns ₹30 NEXUS Coins. Referred friend also gets ₹30 Coins. Simple, trackable, virally effective.

Loop 2: Seller Invites Buyer When a student lists an item, they share the listing link. The buyer clicks, registers, completes transaction — new user acquired at near-zero cost.

Loop 3: Event Sharing Events create shareable posters auto-generated by NEXUS. Every share is a new user acquisition funnel.

Loop 4: The Hostel Effect Target one hostel per week. Once 30–40% of a hostel uses NEXUS (typically for food orders and errands), peer pressure completes the adoption. Offer hostel-specific group discounts.

12.4 Retention Engine

Week 1: Daily check-in bonus in Coins; personalized feed based on department **Month 1:** "You've saved ₹X using NEXUS" milestone notification; achievement badges **Semester 1:** Semester wrap-up: "You earned ₹X on NEXUS this semester" — social sharing moment **Year 1:** NEXUS Annual Report (like Spotify Wrapped for your campus economy)

12.5 Campus Ambassador Program

NEXUS Campus Crew:

- 15–20 paid student ambassadors (₹3,000–₹5,000/month + Coins)
 - Responsibilities: Onboard new users, host mini-events, be the face of NEXUS in their departments
 - Incentive: Top ambassadors get equity interest equivalent through ESOP program (long-term)
 - This is also a leadership development program — builds student loyalty to the brand
-

13. GROWTH & SCALABILITY ROADMAP

13.1 SRM KTR — The Proving Ground (Year 1)

Goal: Achieve 60%+ student penetration, ₹1 Cr+ monthly GMV, positive unit economics.

Milestones:

- Month 1: 2,000 MAU; 5 canteen partnerships; 20 cab drivers
- Month 3: 5,000 MAU; ₹20L GMV; 50 service providers
- Month 6: 10,000 MAU; ₹60L GMV; university official partnership MOU
- Month 12: 15,000 MAU; ₹1 Cr+ GMV; break-even operations

13.2 SRM Network Expansion (Year 1-2)

SRM has multiple campuses: Delhi-NCR, Amaravati, Vadapattinam, Tiruchirapalli.

- Each campus is a separate market with shared tech infrastructure
- Incremental CAC drops dramatically (existing brand recognition, shared codebase)
- Year 2 Target: All 5 SRM campuses live = ~80,000 students

13.3 South India University Expansion (Year 2-3)

Target Institutions:

- VIT Vellore (18,000 students) — similar profile to SRM
- PSG College of Technology, Coimbatore
- Anna University system (CEG, MIT Chennai)
- Amrita University (multiple campuses)
- SASTRA University

Expansion Playbook (The NEXUS Campus Kit):

1. Identify campus ambassador champions (2-3 students) 3 months before launch
2. Sign 3-5 anchor canteen vendors before launch
3. Replicate launch event locally
4. Local team of 2-3 operations staff + campus crew
5. Localized content (Tamil, Hindi-language UI options)
6. Campus-specific features (different mess systems, different hostel layouts)

13.4 Pan-India Expansion (Year 3-5)

Tier 1 Targets: IIT hostels, NIT hostels, BITS campuses **Tier 2:** 50 large private colleges per state

Tier 3: Top 500 colleges via self-serve "NEXUS for Campus" portal

The Self-Serve Model: By Year 3, NEXUS should be launchable at a new campus with minimal human intervention:

- Campus admin signs up via web portal
- Bulk invites students via email
- Canteen vendors onboard via self-serve vendor app
- AI handles content moderation, matching, routing

13.5 Beyond Campus — The Long Game (Year 5-10)

Phase 1 — Alumni Networks: Students graduate; NEXUS Alumni network becomes a job/gig/mentorship platform. The trust reputation built as a student carries into professional life.

Phase 2 — Corporate Campus: Technology parks, SEZs, hospital campuses — same closed ecosystem need. "NEXUS for Infosys Campus" — enterprise SaaS model.

Phase 3 — NEXUS Financial Services: Campus-verified users are prime targets for financial products:

- Student credit line (NBFC partnership)
- Campus savings account (bank partnership)
- Expense management for students
- This is the endgame B2C revenue: financial services is the highest-margin segment

Phase 4 — International: Sri Lanka, Bangladesh, Nepal — South Asian university systems with similar dynamics. Then Southeast Asia (Malaysia, Indonesia student populations).

14. TEAM STRUCTURE

14.1 Founding Team Requirements

Role	Responsibilities	Profile
CEO / Co-Founder	Vision, fundraising, university partnerships, growth	Business acumen, network builder, hustler
CTO / Co-Founder	Technical architecture, engineering team leadership	Full-stack engineer, system design experience
CPO / Co-Founder	Product design, UX, feature roadmap	UX/design background, product intuition
COO / Co-Founder	Operations, vendor management, compliance	Operations/logistics experience

Ideal founding team: 2-3 SRM students/alumni with complementary skills + at least one person with startup experience.

14.2 Year 1 Hiring Plan

Role	Count	Type
Full-Stack Engineers	3	Full-time (or equity-heavy)
Mobile Developer (React Native/Flutter)	2	Full-time
UX/UI Designer	1	Full-time

Role	Count	Type
Campus Operations Manager	1	Full-time (SRM alumni)
Community Manager / Campus Crew Lead	1	Full-time
Finance & Compliance Executive	1	Part-time/Consulting
Legal Advisor	1	Retainer

Total Year 1 Team: ~12-15 people including founders.

14.3 Advisory Board

- **University Relations Advisor:** Retired SRM faculty or administrator
- **Legal Advisor:** Chennai-based startup lawyer with fintech experience
- **Payments Advisor:** Someone from Razorpay/PhonePe background
- **VC Advisor:** Angel investor or early-stage VC familiar with consumer apps
- **Safety Advisor:** Former law enforcement or campus security professional

15. FUNDING STRATEGY

15.1 Pre-Seed (₹0 to ₹50L)

Sources:

- Founder bootstrapping + friends & family
- SRM TechPark / Incubator (SRMU has its own incubation cell — approach them)
- Government grants: Startup India Seed Fund Scheme (up to ₹20L for eligible startups)
- Chennai/Tamil Nadu startup grants (TANSIM — Tamil Nadu Startup & Innovation Mission)

Milestone Unlocked: MVP built, 2,000 users, ₹10L GMV proven.

15.2 Seed Round (₹50L to ₹3 Cr)

Timing: 6-9 months after launch (when product-market fit is clear) **Sources:**

- Indian angel investors (Chennai, Bangalore, Delhi NCR-based)
- Angel networks: Indian Angel Network, Mumbai Angels, LetsVenture
- Campus-specific investors (edtech-adjacent VCs)
- **Target VCs:** Blume Ventures, Kalaari Capital, Stellaris Venture Partners (known for early-stage India consumer)

Pitch Narrative: "We are the Gojek of Indian campuses — and we've proven it at SRM."

15.3 Series A (₹15 Cr to ₹50 Cr)

Timing: 18-24 months after launch (when multi-campus expansion is proven) **Milestone Required:** 5+ campuses, ₹5 Cr+ annual GMV, clear path to 50 campuses **Target VCs:** Sequoia India/Surge, Accel India, Tiger Global, Matrix Partners India

15.4 The ESOP Culture

From Day 1, NEXUS builds an ESOP pool of 10% for early employees and campus ambassadors. This is how we attract talent without cash — and create co-owners of the mission.

16. RISKS & MITIGATION

Risk	Probability	Impact	Mitigation
University refuses official partnership	Medium	High	Build user base first; university follows students
Fraud/scam incident goes viral	Medium	High	Escrow system + rapid PR response playbook
Regulatory crackdown on ride-sharing	Low	High	Structure rides as cost-sharing; legal opinion
WhatsApp group inertia (habit stickiness)	High	Medium	Convenience + trust + coins > WhatsApp
Competitor (Swiggy, Ola) launches campus product	Low	High	Speed + trust moat; university exclusivity
Technical outage during peak	Medium	Medium	Multi-region deployment; redundancy
Low vendor adoption	Medium	High	White-glove onboarding team; free first month
Student safety incident on platform	Low	Critical	Background verification, GPS tracking, SOS button, zero-tolerance policy
Payment gateway regulatory change	Low	Medium	Multiple PA relationships (Razorpay + backup)
Data breach	Low	Critical	Encryption, security audits, minimal PII storage

17. FINANCIAL PROJECTIONS

17.1 Unit Economics (Per SRM Campus)

Metric	Month 3	Month 6	Month 12
MAU	4,000	9,000	15,000
GMV/month	₹15L	₹55L	₹1.2 Cr
Take Rate	10%	11%	12%
Net Revenue/month	₹1.5L	₹6L	₹14.4L
Burn Rate/month	₹8L	₹10L	₹12L
Cash Flow	-₹6.5L	-₹4L	+₹2.4L

Break-even: ~Month 14 for SRM KTR campus.

17.2 Multi-Campus Projections (Year 3)

Metric	Value
Active Campuses	12
Total MAU	1,20,000
Total GMV/month	₹12 Cr
Net Revenue/month	₹1.5 Cr
Net Revenue/year	₹18 Cr
EBITDA Margin	15-20%

18. FUTURE VISION — 10-YEAR HORIZON

2024-2025: SRM KTR dominance. Proof of concept. **2026:** SRM multi-campus. Seed funding. **2027:** 10 South Indian campuses. Series A. **2028:** 50 campuses Pan-India. Series B. **2029:** 200 campuses. Launch financial services. **2030:** 500 campuses. Corporate campus product. International pilots. **2032:** NEXUS IPO. The "Gojek of Indian campuses." 10M+ users. **2034:** South & Southeast Asia expansion.

The North Star Metric:

% of a student's campus spending that flows through NEXUS.

When that number hits 60% at 500 campuses, NEXUS is an infrastructure company — not just an app. And infrastructure companies don't get disrupted. They become the platform others build on.

"Every city has a heartbeat. Every campus has a NEXUS."

NEXUS Campus Technologies Pvt. Ltd. Confidential — For Founders' Reference Only Version 1.0 / 2024